Combined Flex Installation Guide (Windows, macOS, Linux)

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📘 FLEX INSTALLATION IN WINDOWS

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Step 1: Download WinFlexBison

Download from:

https://github.com/lexxmark/winflexbison/releases

File example:

win_flex_bison-<version>.zip

Step 2: Extract ZIP

Extract to:

C:\WinFlexBison\

You will find:

- win_flex.exe
- win_bison.exe

(Optional) Rename:

win_flex.exe → flex.exe

win_bison.exe → bison.exe

Step 3: Add to PATH

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1. Search "Environment Variables"

2. Open → System Variables → Path → Edit

3. Add:

   C:\WinFlexBison\

Step 4: Verify

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   flex --version

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🍏 FLEX INSTALLATION IN macOS

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Install via Homebrew (Recommended)

Step 1: Install Homebrew:

   /bin/bash -c "$(curl -fsSL https://raw.githubusercontent.com/Homebrew/install/HEAD/install.sh)"

Step 2: Install Flex:

   brew install flex

Step 3: Verify:

```
flex --version
```

(Optional) Install GCC:

```
brew install gcc
```

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🐧 FLEX INSTALLATION IN LINUX

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Ubuntu / Debian

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install flex
```

Fedora / RHEL / CentOS

```
sudo dnf install flex
```

Arch / Manjaro

```
sudo pacman -S flex
```

Verify:

```
flex --version
```

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🛠️ COMPILING FLEX PROGRAMS (All Systems)

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File: lexer.l

Step 1: Generate C file:

```
flex lexer.l
```

Produces:

```
lex.yy.c
```

Step 2: Compile:

```
gcc lex.yy.c -o lexer
```

Step 3: Run:

```
./lexer
```